

Q.6c (15 marks): Production distribution and exchange in simple societies

को नियंत्रित करने वाले सिद्धांत निर्वाह गतिविधि के आधार पर किस प्रकार भिन्न होते हैं।

Discuss, with ethnographic examples, how the principles governing production, distribution and exchange in simple societies differ based on (subsistence activity). 15

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Aristotle calls humans as 'Homo Economicus' highlighting that wherever a group of humans come together, a functioning economy exists.

Principles of production, distribution & Exchange based on Subsistence Activity

① Hunter gatherers: !Kung, Chenchi.

(a) Production: (i) depend on hunting & natural resources.

(ii) Seasonal in nature & face less food scarcity.

(b) Distribution: (i) Equal sharing & no surplus.

(ii) Reciprocity dominates the distribution.

(iii) Lack of storage hinder long

term accumulation.

(C) Exchange

(i) reciprocity as main form of exchange

(ii) Tribes like Veddas & Praja engage in exchange with local settled communities

② Hunter-fishing | eg → Kwakiutl of British Columbia.

(a) Production (i) depend on fishing, using technology like canoe, harpoons, nets, etc.

(b) Distribution : elaborate storage mechanism. ~~Barter~~ & reciprocity within community & Trade with outsiders

(c) Exchange : both commercial & Ceremonial exchange coexist

③ Pastoralists | eg → Toda of Nilgiri | eg → Bassein of Iran

a) Production : depend on domesticated

animals like sheep, goat, buffalo.

b) [Distribution]: Existence of private property, ~~barter~~ Balanced reciprocity dominates.

(c) [Exchange]: barter trade with other communities. Both ceremonial & commercial exchange exist.

④ [Agriculturists]: include slash & burn horticulturists like Naga, Kuki

a) [Production]: on a cleared plot of forest, not intensive in nature.

(b) [Distribution]: Existence of Storage, private properties & some inequality

(c) [Exchange]: ~~both~~ usually barter exchange but reciprocity both positive & balanced exist

Thus, as Culture ecology points — social institutions are impacted by environment they operate in.

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